



VIDEO TWO · CAPABILITY FORMATION

Is Your Job Making You Less Marketable?

Temidayo Afonja · temidayoafonja.com

TWO DIFFERENT QUESTIONS

**Success answers one
of them at a time.**

Valuable here

Legible elsewhere

Current success can answer one question
while leaving the other unresolved.

THREE MARKETABILITY TESTS

01

Remove the company nouns

Can the capability still be described?

TEST ONE

Remove the company nouns.

Cross out the employer, the internal programs, the systems, the product names and the acronyms. Read what is left.

Company-bound description

**I own the QBR process
for this business unit.**

TEST ONE

Remove the company nouns.

Cross out the employer, the internal programs, the systems, the product names and the acronyms. Read what is left.

Company-bound description

**I own the QBR process
for this business unit.**



What another employer
can understand

**I combine incomplete operating
data, surface the decision leaders
are avoiding, and create a shared
view of what needs to happen next.**

THREE MARKETABILITY TESTS

02

Find outside-context evidence

Has the usefulness survived a change in context?

TEST TWO

Find outside-context evidence.

The evidence can be small. It only has to show the usefulness survived some distance from where it was formed.

01 **Cross-functional project**

Another group used or sought your judgment.

TEST TWO

Find outside-context evidence.

The evidence can be small. It only has to show the usefulness survived some distance from where it was formed.

01 **Cross-functional project**

Another group used or sought your judgment.

02 **External client or customer**

The capability created value beyond your immediate team.

TEST TWO

Find outside-context evidence.

The evidence can be small. It only has to show the usefulness survived some distance from where it was formed.

01 **Cross-functional project**

Another group used or sought your judgment.

02 **External client or customer**

The capability created value beyond your immediate team.

03 **Former colleague**

They sought your judgment after the original context changed.

TEST TWO

Find outside-context evidence.

The evidence can be small. It only has to show the usefulness survived some distance from where it was formed.

01 **Cross-functional project**

Another group used or sought your judgment.

02 **External client or customer**

The capability created value beyond your immediate team.

03 **Former colleague**

They sought your judgment after the original context changed.

04 **Another setting or industry contribution**

A similar problem or approach remained useful elsewhere.

THREE MARKETABILITY TESTS

03

Read the last 90 days

What new judgment did the work build?

TEST THREE

Read the last 90 days.

What can you now do, see or decide that you could not do ninety days ago?

New judgment

Same work faster

TEST THREE

Read the last 90 days.

What can you now do, see or decide that you could not do ninety days ago?

New judgment

Same work faster

01 What unfamiliar problem did I have to solve?

TEST THREE

Read the last 90 days.

What can you now do, see or decide that you could not do ninety days ago?

New judgment

Same work faster

- 01 What unfamiliar problem did I have to solve?
- 02 What decision can I now make with less help?

TEST THREE

Read the last 90 days.

What can you now do, see or decide that you could not do ninety days ago?

New judgment

Same work faster

- 01 What unfamiliar problem did I have to solve?
- 02 What decision can I now make with less help?
- 03 What constraint, audience or context did I learn to work across?

THE THREE TESTS

Together they separate internal value from external marketability.

01

**Remove the
company nouns**

02

**Find outside-context
evidence**

03

**Read the
last 90 days**

READING THE PATTERN

Read them together.

Is my judgment growing?

Can another context use it?

One familiar sign is not a diagnosis. Read the pattern across growth and portability, and keep the reading provisional.

BEFORE YOU LEAVE

What can I change before I leave?

A concern in one test does not mean the answer is to resign.
Choose one thing to test in the next thirty days.

01 **Ask for work that creates new judgment, not only more volume.**

BEFORE YOU LEAVE

What can I change before I leave?

A concern in one test does not mean the answer is to resign.
Choose one thing to test in the next thirty days.

- 01 **Ask for work that creates new judgment, not only more volume.**

- 02 **Make the capability visible outside the immediate team or function.**

BEFORE YOU LEAVE

What can I change before I leave?

A concern in one test does not mean the answer is to resign.
Choose one thing to test in the next thirty days.

- 01 **Ask for work that creates new judgment, not only more volume.**

- 02 **Make the capability visible outside the immediate team or function.**

- 03 **Document knowledge or results that exist mainly in your head.**

BEFORE YOU LEAVE

What can I change before I leave?

A concern in one test does not mean the answer is to resign.
Choose one thing to test in the next thirty days.

- 01 **Ask for work that creates new judgment, not only more volume.**

- 02 **Make the capability visible outside the immediate team or function.**

- 03 **Document knowledge or results that exist mainly in your head.**

- 04 **Take on an adjacent problem that forces the capability into a different context.**

THE CAPABILITY FORMATION FIELD KIT

Is your job still building you?

Complete a private, evidence-led career position assessment using the last 90 days of your actual work.

temidayoafonja.com/fieldkit

Part Two: Optionality
Market portability. Six statements, out of 30.

7. The capability I am building would be valued by an employer in a different market.
EVIDENCE (last ninety days):

8. I can describe what I do in terms of outcomes, not just my company's processes.
EVIDENCE (last ninety days):

9. If my role disappeared tomorrow, the capability I built would still be valuable.
EVIDENCE (last ninety days):

10. People with the power to hire or advance me, inside or outside my company, see what I am good at.
EVIDENCE (last ninety days):

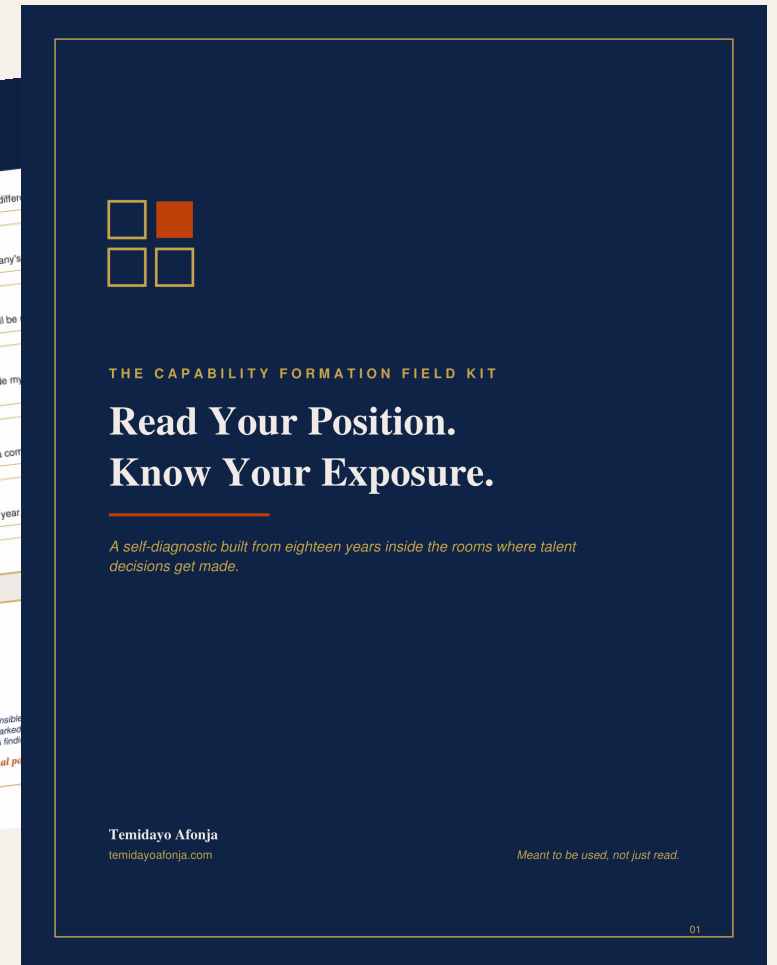
11. What I am learning is a transferable capability rather than a company-specific skill.
EVIDENCE (last ninety days):

12. I could rebuild a strong position somewhere else within a year.
EVIDENCE (last ninety days):

Add the six answers. Optionality score (out of 30):

If you cannot support a score either way, write your most defensible score. Do not force it downward and do not default to a 3. One or two marked mean you do not have ninety days of evidence on that axis. A final score without an evidence line is a guess with decimal points.

The Capability Formation Field Kit | Temidayo Afonja



WATCH NEXT

Before You Quit Your Job, Check These 3 Things

